

Come, go, bring, and take

Teaching guide

Describe movement from a clear point of view.

Understand the distinction

Come often describes movement toward the speaker, listener, or an agreed meeting place. Go commonly describes movement away or toward another place. Bring and take describe similar movement with a person or thing.

The viewpoint can be a future location. On the phone, I am coming to your office treats the listener as the destination. Bring your notes to our meeting uses the shared meeting as the reference point. Context can make more than one choice natural.

Compare the patterns

TOWARD US

Can you come to my desk?

The speaker is the destination.

ANOTHER PLACE

I need to go to the bank.

The bank is another destination.

WITH SOMETHING

Please bring your notes to our meeting.

The notes move toward the shared meeting.

Read each example. Explain what the highlighted choice means in context. Then cover the example and say a similar sentence.

Check your understanding

Write before looking at the answers. The guide gives a model answer and explains the choice. Other wording can be correct.

1. You are at home inviting a friend. Complete: Please ___ over.

2. You are leaving home for class. Complete: I must ___ my book with me.

3. Can come refer to the listener's location?

Use it in your own life

Invite someone somewhere and say what to bring.

Self-check

Does your sentence express your intended meaning? Does its form follow the relevant pattern? Can a reader understand the context?

Try again

After checking the explanation, revise your sentence. Say it aloud or use it in a short conversation.

Answers and explanation

1. come

The friend moves toward you.

2. take

You carry the book away from your current location.

3. Yes: I am coming to your office.

The viewpoint can be the listener or a shared destination.

One possible response

Come to my house for lunch. Please bring a drink.

This is a model, not the only acceptable answer. Assess meaning, grammar, and context together.

Continue learning

Web lesson and related topics: englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-11.html

A practical teaching sequence

1. Notice (2 minutes)

Ask learners to explain the differences between the comparison examples before reading the rules. Use their answers to identify the point that needs attention.

2. Explain and check (4 minutes)

Read the short explanation together. Keep its qualifications: a common pattern is not necessarily a rule for every context. Ask learners to give a counterexample where the lesson mentions an exception.

3. Apply (5 minutes)

Invite someone somewhere and say what to bring.

Have learners work alone, then compare with a partner. Ask the partner to restate the intended meaning before suggesting a correction.

4. Review (3 minutes)

Use the answer explanations to review the three checks. Accept natural alternatives that preserve the intended meaning. Ask each learner to revise one sentence and identify the change.

Extension

Change the person, time, place, or purpose in a comparison example. Ask whether the original pattern still fits and why. Revisit one example in the next lesson.

Feedback criteria

Meaning: the message is understandable. Form: the target pattern fits the context. Transfer: the learner can use it in a fresh example. This short activity is not a proficiency certification.